

Exercises

14.1 Complete the sentences.

- 1 Isabella is only six months old – she’s still a baby.
- 2 Louis was 22 a few months ago, so he’s in his
- 3 Amelia is 35, so she’s in her
- 4 Abigail will be 13 this year, so she’ll soon be a
- 5 William is 53 and his wife is 47, so they’re both
- 6 Joan is 80 this year, so she is quite
- 7 Michael was a bus driver for 40 years but he’s now
- 8 Leon is 18 this year, so legally he becomes
- 9 The boys are 14 and 16, so they’re both in their
- 10 Holly is just over a year old and she’s starting to walk, so she’s a now.

14.2 Are the sentences true or false about Mary’s life on the opposite page? If a sentence is false, change it to make it true.

- 1 Mary was brought up in the city. False. Mary was brought up on a farm.
- 2 She grew up in Wales.
- 3 Her parents let her do what she wanted.
- 4 She wasn’t allowed to listen to the radio.
- 5 Life was easy when she went to Cardiff.
- 6 She couldn’t get a job in Cardiff.

14.3 Rewrite the sentences without using the underlined words and phrases. Keep a similar meaning.

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| 1 My parents <u>are dead</u> now. | My parents <u>aren’t alive now</u> |
| 2 It was hard but <u>finally</u> I did it. | It was hard but |
| 3 She’s <u>approximately</u> my age. | She’s |
| 4 They’re <u>almost</u> thirty now. | They’re |
| 5 <u>I had to do what</u> my parents <u>wanted</u> . | My parents were |
| 6 My parents <u>let me</u> stay up and watch TV. | I was |
| 7 My mum <u>looked after me</u> in Scotland. | I was |
| 8 I <u>was able to</u> pass my exams <u>but it wasn’t easy</u> . | I |
| 9 I <u>didn’t go home until</u> late. | I |
| 10 <u>I was allowed to</u> wear what I liked. | My parents |
| 11 I was happy <u>as a child</u> . | I had a happy |
| 12 My grandparents <u>don’t work any more</u> . | My grandparents are |

14.4 Over to you

Answer the questions. If possible, ask a friend and write their answers.

- 1 Where were you brought up?
- 2 What do you particularly remember about your childhood?
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- 3 Were your parents strict? What weren’t you allowed to do when you were a child?
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- 4 How late were you allowed to stay out when you were a teenager?
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